01. Trade Corridors, Logistics, & Economic Connectivity

The architecture of global trade rests, ultimately, on physical infrastructure — on ports, rail lines, fibre cables, and the corridors of overland transit that connect production to consumption. This module examines the strategic significance of that architecture in a moment when economic connectivity has become inseparable from geopolitical positioning. Once treated as the quiet plumbing of globalisation, logistics corridors are today instruments of statecraft: their routing, ownership, and capacity shape not only the flow of goods but the alignment of regions.

The module considers the major contemporary corridors that are reorganising international trade — the Belt and Road Initiative, the India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor, the Trans-Caspian Middle Corridor, ASEAN connectivity frameworks, and the renewed strategic interest in maritime chokepoints from the Strait of Malacca to the Bab-el-Mandeb. Delegates will engage with the logic of port concessions, the politics of free trade zones, the interaction between connectivity and sovereignty, and the question of how middle powers position themselves within corridors designed by others.

Particular attention is given to Southeast Asia's position at the intersection of multiple corridor projects, and to Indonesia's own emerging role as both a maritime hub and a sovereign actor shaping its own connectivity agenda. The module equips delegates to read the map of global trade not only as commerce but as a strategic geography in which infrastructure is policy made permanent.

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02. Global Financial Centers & the New Geography of Capital

The map of global finance is being redrawn. The traditional axis of London, New York, and Tokyo now shares the stage with Singapore, Dubai, Shanghai, Hong Kong, Frankfurt, Mumbai, and a rising tier of regional centres each competing for capital, talent, and regulatory authority. This module examines how financial hubs are made — and what the redistribution of financial power among them means for the conduct of international economic policy.

Delegates will explore the institutional foundations of a financial centre: regulatory regimes, judicial independence, talent ecosystems, currency convertibility, and the soft infrastructure of trust on which capital ultimately depends. The module considers the rise of sovereign wealth funds as a force in the contemporary financial system, the strategic competition between centres to attract listings and headquarters, and the role of cities as economic actors in their own right — distinct from the states that house them.

Discussions will engage with the geography of green finance, Islamic finance and the GCC's growing capital architecture, the offshore-onshore continuum, and the question of how digital assets and central bank digital currencies are altering the basis on which financial centres compete. The module asks delegates to consider not only where capital flows, but why — and what the redirection of those flows tells us about the underlying balance of confidence in the international system.

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03. AI, Automation, & Economic Competitiveness

Artificial intelligence and automation are reshaping the foundations of economic competitiveness more rapidly than any previous technological transformation. This module examines what that means — for productivity, for labour markets, for the comparative advantage of nations, and for the contemporary social contract on which economic policy depends.

The module engages with the strategic question facing governments at every income level: how to position a national economy within a global technological hierarchy increasingly shaped by access to compute, data, and frontier capability. Delegates will explore the policy responses adopted in different jurisdictions — the EU AI Act, the United States' export controls on advanced semiconductors, China's industrial policy, and the strategic positioning of states that host neither the labs nor the chip fabs but seek to participate meaningfully in the AI economy.

Substantive attention is given to the labour-market implications of automation, the productivity paradox that has accompanied earlier technological shifts, and the open question of whether AI will compress or widen the gap between developed and developing economies. The module also considers the cultural dimensions of competitiveness — the role of education systems, research universities, and creative ecosystems in producing the kind of human capital that complements rather than competes with machine intelligence. Delegates leave equipped to think about technological change not only as opportunity, but as a question of national strategic adaptation.

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04. Venture Capital, Startup Ecosystems, & Innovation

Innovation has become a category of statecraft. The question of how nations build, attract, and sustain ecosystems capable of producing transformative enterprises now occupies finance ministries and foreign ministries alike. This module examines the architecture of innovation — the interaction of venture capital, university research, regulatory environments, and cultural attitudes toward risk that together determine whether a city or country becomes a generator of new economic value or a consumer of it.

Delegates will engage with the structure of the venture capital industry — its sources of capital, its incentive design, and its concentration in a small number of jurisdictions — and with the policy instruments that governments have used to seed and scale domestic ecosystems. The module considers the experience of Silicon Valley alongside the deliberately constructed ecosystems of Singapore, Tel Aviv, Bengaluru, Shenzhen, Dubai, and Jakarta itself, attending to what travels across contexts and what does not.

Particular attention is given to the rise of sovereign-backed venture funds, the role of corporate venture capital in shaping emerging sectors, and the strategic questions raised by foreign investment in early-stage technology firms with national-security implications. The module also examines the present moment for Southeast Asian innovation — the maturing of Indonesian, Vietnamese, and Philippine startup ecosystems — and what this regional shift means for the global geography of where the next generation of consequential firms will be founded.

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05. Economic Statecraft & Strategic Infrastructure

Economic statecraft — the deliberate use of economic instruments in pursuit of national strategic objectives — has returned to the centre of international relations after a generation in which it sat at the margins. This module examines the contemporary toolkit of economic statecraft and the central role of strategic infrastructure within it, attending in particular to how states are now thinking about the long-term positioning of their economies as instruments of national power.

Delegates will engage with the spectrum of economic statecraft instruments — sanctions, export controls, investment screening, industrial policy, strategic stockpiling, sovereign wealth deployment, and the deliberate routing of supply chains — and with the institutional architecture through which these instruments are now coordinated. The module considers the rise of "friendshoring" and supply-chain diversification, the contemporary politics of critical minerals and rare earths, and the strategic questions raised by national investment in semiconductors, energy infrastructure, and digital systems.

Substantive attention is given to the asymmetries that economic statecraft makes visible — between the states that can wield the instruments and the states that are subject to them — and to the strategic options available to middle powers and emerging economies seeking to navigate this terrain. The module also considers how strategic infrastructure, once built, shapes future policy choices for decades. Delegates leave with a structured understanding of how economic instruments are now being mobilised in service of strategic position, and of the long horizons on which such instruments operate.

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06. North–South Cooperation & Regional Integration

The architecture of international cooperation is undergoing a recomposition. The traditional categories of North and South, developed and developing, donor and recipient, are being supplemented and in places displaced by a more textured map of regional integration projects, South–South partnerships, and middle-power coalitions. This module examines that recomposition — and the new openings it creates for cooperation that crosses, rather than reinforces, older hierarchies.

Delegates will engage with the principal frameworks of regional integration relevant to the contemporary moment: ASEAN and its expanding economic community, the African Continental Free Trade Area, BRICS in its expanded form, the Gulf Cooperation Council, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, and the renewed conversation around development finance led by institutions outside the traditional Bretton Woods architecture. The module considers what these frameworks have achieved, where they have struggled, and how they are now being reshaped by the geopolitical pressures of the present decade.

Particular attention is given to the Global South's renewed assertion of agency — in the climate negotiations, in debt restructuring, in the reform of multilateral institutions — and to the role of middle powers in convening cooperation across regional lines. The module asks delegates to consider how a country like Indonesia, which is at once a G20 economy, an ASEAN anchor, a leading voice of the Non-Aligned Movement, and a Muslim-majority democracy, can shape the architecture of cooperation rather than receive it. Delegates leave equipped to read the contemporary map of regional integration as an active terrain of strategic choice.